SOFTWARE ENGINEERING & ARCHITECTURE

Adam *Riddick.*

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Principal Architect | United Kingdom

I'm a Principal Architect with 13+ years in software engineering. My work spans SaaS modernisation, .NET development and engineering leadership. I work with teams from early design choices through implementation and production, making the decisions understandable to the people who will keep changing and operating the system.

Selected *work.*

SaaS platform modernisation

IRIS Software Group | Senior Architect, then Senior Manager, Engineering

Owned the modernisation plan and technical direction, working with product and engineering teams to evolve a legacy platform. Defined API-first, multi-tenant .NET components alongside a single-tenant backbone and database, with microservices and event-driven integration on Azure.

The teams delivered Central Reporting, the Integrations Platform and a modern authentication server used by 2 million+ people each month. Shared standards and a development lifecycle supported peer review and subsequent delivery.

Cloud modernisation and provisioning

IRIS Software Group | Senior Architect | June 2020 - July 2025

Led migration planning and Azure, .NET and SQL Server design across three products, working with developers from early options through implementation. The work balanced legacy compatibility, security and operating costs. Team delivery reduced hosting costs and brought environment provisioning from days to hours.

Azure costs and service recovery

IRIS Software Group | Senior Manager, Engineering | July 2025 - October 2026

Worked across engineering and operations on backups, resource sizing and infrastructure retirement, producing substantial recurring Azure savings. Teams improved observability, incident detection and response, significantly reducing average recovery time. Clearer service ownership connected the improvements to the people operating the systems.

Adam Riddick
Principal Architect
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Career *history.*

Senior Manager, Engineering

IRIS Software Group | July 2025 - October 2026

Led internationally distributed engineering teams across the UK, Eastern Europe and India, overseeing technology delivery for an education software portfolio generating £25m+ in annual recurring revenue.

Led engineering for Global Payments and partnered with Product on portal renewal and integration design. Teams adopted a shared development lifecycle and substantially increased release frequency.

Embedded security controls and audit evidence into delivery for ISO 27001, ISO 9001 and Cyber Essentials certification. Teams resolved all engineering audit findings. Led cross-team security discussions covering penetration testing and technical due diligence.

Senior Architect

IRIS Software Group | June 2020 - July 2025

Shaped architecture across three products spanning core applications, integrations, reporting, HR and compliance. Developed technical roadmaps with Engineering, Product and senior stakeholders.

Designed and reviewed cross-product APIs and integrations, including identity, data isolation and shared-service operations. Established standards through design reviews, threat modelling and secure coding guidance; mentored engineers on technical decisions.

Earlier experience

iSAMS | Senior Software Engineer | June 2016 - June 2020

PJA Group | Software Development Team Lead | June 2014 - June 2016

Simpson Group | .NET Analyst and Developer | June 2013 - June 2014

Technical *experience.*

Architecture: SaaS and hybrid architectures, legacy modernisation, multi-tenancy, tenant isolation, API-first design, microservices and event-driven integration.

Cloud and applications: Microsoft Azure, C#/.NET, Stencil.js/TypeScript, cloud migration and cost optimisation.

Data: SQL Server, Snowflake, Fivetran, data integration and business intelligence.

Identity and security: IdentityServer, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, SAML 2.0, single sign-on, threat modelling and secure design.

Delivery: Infrastructure as code, CI/CD, DevOps automation, Datadog, observability and incident response.

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Computer Science, First Class Honours | Teesside University, 2015

Microsoft DevOps Engineer Expert | Awarded 2023

Four Top Talent Awards | Platinum recognition